

The most unusual festivals

Since this is a festive period and most of you will be in a festive mood, we think it'll be a good time to educate you on some of the most unusual festivals celebrated around the world today. From jumping over new born babies to setting out a buffet for monkeys. Many of these festivals have a deep religious significance to the people concerned so try not to laugh!



El Colacho

A centuries old tradition involving grown men dressing up as "devils" and jumping over neat rows of new born babies on mattresses. This unusual tradition is considered to be the most dangerous festival in the world. Ignoring the risk of a grown man landing on a baby, how would you like it if your first memories involve devils jumping over your head?

Monkey buffet

A feast laid out in the honour of Lord Hanuman, yes our very own Lord Hanuman, the Monkey Buffet is laid out every year in Lopburi, Thailand. A lavish layout of fresh fruits and whatever stuff monkeys like to eat is meant to entice these primates to the area. Look at the little critter below, now doesn't it look so happy?



Boryeong Mud Festival

Your parents must have always told you not to eat or play in mud. If that always rankled you, you should have been born Korean. Mud from the Boryeong is trucked to Daecheon to create a "Mud Experience Land". Did you ever imagine mud could be so much fun? Rebel! Head over to South Korea, show your parents the true nature of mud!



Noche de Rábanos

Celebrated since 1897, this Spanish festival involves the creation and presentation of some of the most stupendous art sculptures ever seen. Some of them can weigh up to 3 kg! Only 3 kg? Yep. These sculptures are made from radishes. Craftsmen and aficionados from all over Spain showcase some of the most detailed radish sculptures ever seen.

The Redneck Games

Involving such high-brow sports as seed spitting, mud-pit belly-flop and armpit-serenade, this annual event began as a protest against a snide remark regarding the hosting of the 1996 Olympic games in America. No, don't turn your nose up at this. Are you capable of serenading your loved one with armpit music? Well, a 12-year old kid can do it better than you.



Naki Sumo baby crying

This is an event held in Sensoji Temple, Tokyo. A 400-year old tradition involving towering sumo wrestlers holding babies high above their heads to see which one cries first! The baby who cries the longest and loudest is the winner. Made to cry by oversized men dressed in pseudo-diapers is not our idea of fun. But, well, to each his own.